

English, Grade 12

Workplace Preparation

ENG4E

This course emphasizes the consolidation of literacy, communication, and critical and creative thinking skills necessary for success in the workplace and in daily life. Students will analyse informational, graphic, and literary texts and create oral, written, and media texts in a variety of forms for workplace-related and practical purposes. An important focus will be on using language accurately and organizing ideas and information coherently. The course is intended to prepare students for the workplace and active citizenship.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 11, Workplace Preparation

Key to Footnote References

The footnotes throughout this course contain abbreviated references to teacher resource guides in the ministry's "Think Literacy Library", available on the ministry website, at www.edu.gov.on.ca. The guides are identified as follows:

- TLCC 7-12 refers to the main guide, *Think Literacy: Cross-Curricular Approaches, Grades 7-12*.
- TLE 7-9 and TLE 10-12 refer to the subject-specific guides for Language/English, Grades 7-9, and English, Grades 10-12.
- Other subject-specific guides are identified by the initials "TL", followed by the name of the subject (e.g., Computer Integration; Library Research; Media; Technological Education) and the grades the resource guide covers (e.g., TL Computer Integration 7-12).

ORAL COMMUNICATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Listening to Understand:** listen in order to understand and respond appropriately in a variety of situations for a variety of purposes;
- 2. Speaking to Communicate:** use speaking skills and strategies appropriately to communicate with different audiences for a variety of purposes;
- 3. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as listeners and speakers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in oral communication situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

- 1.1** identify the purpose of a variety of listening tasks and set goals for specific tasks (*e.g., listen to the lyrics from a soundtrack of a skateboard video to identify mood; listen to an online news clip to identify tone and bias; listen to a peer's read-aloud in order to offer advice;*¹ *listen to an audio clip from an online source to gather information for a celebrity biography*)

Teacher prompts: "What are some of the words you hear repeated in the song? How do they contribute to the mood of the song?" "How did the narrator's tone convey her feelings about the other characters in the story?"

Using Active Listening Strategies

- 1.2** select and use appropriate active listening strategies when participating in a variety of classroom interactions (*e.g., apply verbal and non-verbal cues while listening; use body language that sustains, encourages, and facilitates discussion;*² *make notes to record key points during a speech*)

Teacher prompt: "What listening strategies do you use to encourage newcomers to participate in a discussion?"

Using Listening Comprehension Strategies

- 1.3** select and use appropriate listening comprehension strategies before, during, and after listening to understand oral texts, including

increasingly complex texts (*e.g., take point-form notes to record information from a presentation about apprenticeships; use student-generated headings to organize information after listening; use the jigsaw method to share ideas and extend knowledge of the topic;*³ *after conducting an interview, organize the responses in preparation for writing an article*)

Teacher prompts: "How did you identify your purpose for listening? How did having a focus for listening help you to organize your note-taking?" "How does jotting down questions while you are listening help you to understand?"

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- 1.4** identify the important information and ideas in oral texts, including increasingly complex texts, in a variety of ways (*e.g., create a display or a promotional pamphlet based on a speaker's presentation about a career option; create a flyer for a new student that summarizes the information given in a grade-level assembly; create a timeline that highlights the key events in a crime story*⁴)

Teacher prompt: "What were the highlights of the presentation? What part of the presentation was most relevant to you? What formats can you use to share the information you gathered during the presentation?"

Interpreting Texts

- 1.5** develop and explain interpretations of oral texts, including increasingly complex texts, using evidence from the text and the oral and visual cues used in it to support their interpretations (*e.g., dramatize key messages*)

1. TLE 7-9 "Read Aloud" 28 2. TLCC 7-12 "Discussion Etiquette" 176 3. TLCC 7-12 "Jigsaw" 170 4. TLCC 7-12 "Determining Key Ideas" 166

on the importance of teamwork, using the ideas and information presented in a teacher-directed lesson)

Teacher prompt: “What elements of the speech helped you to write your summary?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

- 1.6** extend understanding of oral texts, including increasingly complex texts, by making connections between the ideas in them and personal knowledge, experience, and insights; other texts; and the world around them (e.g., *listen to the dialogue in a video of a workplace situation to compare the quality of the employee/employer communication with their own experiences in the workplace; explain how the ideas in an oral text relate to a social issue in the local community; discuss, with a partner, similarities and differences between the ideas in an oral text and their own ideas*)

Teacher prompt: “How does this situation compare with your experiences in the workplace? What advice would you give to the employers about how to communicate effectively?”

Analysing Texts

- 1.7** analyse oral texts, including increasingly complex texts, focusing on the ways in which they communicate information, ideas, issues, and themes and influence the listener’s/viewer’s response (e.g., *examine the informative and persuasive aspects of an army recruitment video;⁵ compare the lyrics used in commercials for two different popular soft drinks to understand how they influence the audience*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you notice about the narration in this video? Who is speaking? What parts of this message appeal to you? Why?”

Critical Literacy

- 1.8** identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in oral texts, including increasingly complex oral texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *identify people and perspectives not represented in popular network talk shows; analyse infomercial testimonials; analyse the campaign speeches of student council candidates*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the speaker’s purpose or motive?” “What is the speaker’s bias towards the subject?” “How does the speaker challenge your own biases towards the subject?”

Understanding Presentation Strategies

- 1.9** evaluate the effectiveness of a variety of presentation strategies used in oral texts, including increasingly complex texts, and suggest other strategies that could be used effectively (e.g., *evaluate the use of visual aids such as costumes, props, diagrams, or slides to enhance the oral text; assess the effectiveness of oral communication strategies used in presentations by recruitment personnel from postsecondary institutions*)

Teacher prompts: “What does this costume communicate about the character?” “How could the use of costumes or props distract a listener rather than support the communication of a message?”

2. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

- 2.1** communicate orally for a variety of purposes, using language appropriate for the intended audience (e.g., *discuss with a peer the reasons to attend a job fair; rehearse answers for a job interview; identify for a small group the values, priorities, and perspectives presented in a text; present and discuss a writing portfolio at a parent-teacher conference*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you communicate effectively in a job interview? How is speaking in a job interview different from speaking to a customer in the workplace?” “What would you do if you were an employer to communicate effectively in a culturally diverse workplace?”

Interpersonal Speaking Strategies

- 2.2** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of interpersonal speaking strategies and adapt them to suit the purpose, situation, and audience, exhibiting sensitivity to cultural differences (e.g., *role-play handling a customer complaint;⁶ acknowledge classmates’ diverse points of view by affirming their ideas; encourage others in a small group to contribute; adapt speaking based on verbal and non-verbal cues from the audience⁷*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you know when your listener does not understand you? What do you do then?” “What strategies do you use to keep the interest of your listeners?”

5. TL Media 7-10 “Evaluating the Effectiveness of Media Messages” 28 6. TLCC 7-12 “Discussion Etiquette” 176 7. TL ESL/ELD Part II “Talk Show With a Twist” 20

Clarity and Coherence

2.3 communicate in a clear, coherent manner, using a structure and style appropriate to the purpose, subject matter, and intended audience (e.g., *present an argument in favour of one point of view on an issue that includes an opening statement, a sequence of points with supporting evidence, and a conclusion*⁸)

Teacher prompts: “How will you organize your presentation to have the greatest impact within the time frame that you have?” “What is important to know about your audience when you plan the structure of your infomercial?”

Diction and Devices

2.4 use appropriate words, phrases, and terminology, and several different stylistic devices, to communicate their meaning and engage their intended audience (e.g., *use appropriate technical language to describe a co-op placement*⁹; *use sports terms in a presentation about a sports celebrity*; *retell a folk tale to a primary class*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you need to know about your audience in order to use workplace language effectively?” “How would you change the language in a folk tale so that young children could understand and enjoy the story?”

Vocal Strategies

2.5 identify a variety of vocal strategies, including tone, pace, pitch, and volume, and use them appropriately and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences (e.g., *use pauses and changes of pace in a presentation to highlight important points from a research report*¹⁰; *use tone and volume to present and clarify written messages in a school announcement*; *use appropriate tone and volume when addressing customer complaints in a role play*)

Teacher prompts: “When would it be appropriate to adjust the volume of your voice in a small-group discussion? When would it not be appropriate?” “How could you adapt your pace of speaking during your presentation to maintain the interest of your peers?”

Non-Verbal Cues

2.6 identify a variety of non-verbal cues, including facial expressions, gestures, and eye contact, and use them appropriately to help convey their meaning and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences (e.g., *rehearse and use appropriate hand gestures to emphasize points*¹¹; *use appropriate body language and eye*

contact during small-group discussions; *discuss the importance of spatial awareness and use it as appropriate when speaking and interacting with others*)

Teacher prompts: “How does your body language communicate your interest in what you are saying?” “What are some gestures that might help you to communicate more effectively in this situation?”

Audio-Visual Aids

2.7 use a variety of audio-visual aids appropriately to support and enhance oral presentations and to engage an audience (e.g., *use presentation software to convey information to an audience*; *create an illustrated timeline to clarify the order of events discussed in an oral report*¹²; *use handouts to provide relevant information to the audience*)

Teacher prompt: “What information and ideas would have been lost if the speaker had not used the presentation software or the overheads? How else might the speaker have communicated that information? Why would another method have been less effective?”

3. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

3.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after listening and speaking; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify steps they can take to improve their oral communication skills (e.g., *explain strategies they can use in the workplace to help them communicate effectively with customers, other employees, and employers*; *explain to what extent participating in a small-group or class discussion helps them understand the material discussed*)

Teacher prompts: “When you received constructive criticism in the workplace or at school, how did you react?” “What strategies have you used or witnessed others using when dealing with a confrontational situation?” “When you are speaking, what strategies do you use to control how your message is affected by your body language, gestures, and facial expressions?”

8. TLCC 7-12 “Discussion Web” 172 9. TL Library Research 9-12 “Testing Ideas” 28 10. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196 11. TLCC 7-12 “Effective Presentation Skills” 196 12. TLCC 7-12 “Information Report Template” 145

Interconnected Skills

3.2 identify a variety of their skills in viewing, representing, reading, and writing and explain how the skills help them improve their oral communication skills (*e.g., explain how their skills in reading help them participate in a small-group discussion; explain how their understanding of how written texts are organized helps them when they are preparing oral presentations*)

Teacher prompts: “How has viewing this documentary on debate contributed to the development of your speaking skills in a group environment?” “How has writing an analysis of your classmate’s presentation improved and strengthened your own oral communication skills?”

READING AND LITERATURE STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of informational, graphic, and literary texts, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- 2. Understanding Form and Style:** recognize a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements and demonstrate understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- 3. Reading With Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- 1.1** read a variety of short, contemporary, student- and teacher-selected texts that come from diverse cultures and reflect a variety of perspectives on current issues, identifying specific purposes for reading (*e.g., find information in schedules, charts, and tables to complete a workplace task;¹ rehearse a role based on a character in a short story by an Aboriginal writer for a readers' theatre performance;² interpret and evaluate data in a comparison chart about two different brands of a product;³ read a feature magazine article about a new perspective on a current issue for personal interest*)

Teacher prompt: "What different text forms have you read this year? Why are some text forms more difficult to read than others? Why is it important to be able to read different forms?"

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- 1.2** select and use appropriate reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand texts, including increasingly complex texts (*e.g., skim texts to gain an overall impression of their contents and scan texts to locate particular information; use sticky notes to mark significant ideas encountered in technical and workplace texts; reread passages*

that they did not fully understand to clarify ideas; after reading a text, prepare questions for a class discussion)

Teacher prompts: "If you were able to talk to the author of this study, what questions would you ask to help you understand her thesis?" "Now that you've reviewed your notes on the report, can you summarize it for the class?"

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- 1.3** identify the most important ideas and supporting details in texts, including increasingly complex texts (*e.g., explain the information conveyed in a graph; summarize the information provided on a government employment website for teens looking for summer jobs;⁴ outline the plot of a short story; list the evidence provided to support the argument in a newspaper editorial*)

Teacher prompts: "What does this graph tell you about job growth in manufacturing over the past ten years?" "What educational background, skills, and work experience are required for the job you read about on this website?"

Making Inferences

- 1.4** make and explain inferences about texts, including increasingly complex texts, supporting their explanations with well-chosen stated and implied ideas from the texts (*e.g., explain what the design features of a magazine suggest*

1. TL Technological Education 9-12 "Reading Graphical and Informational Texts" 14, 20 2. TLE 10-12 "Readers' Theatre" 122
3. TLCC 7-12 "I Read, I Think, Therefore" 73 4. TL Library Research 7-12 "Looking for Relationships" 24

about its target audience; explain what the dialogue between two characters reveals about their motives; make inferences about salary on the basis of the wording of a job description)

Teacher prompts: “What does the illustration in this magazine article suggest about the author’s message?” “Is there a moral that we can infer from the story?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

- 1.5** extend understanding of texts, including increasingly complex texts, by making appropriate connections between the ideas in them and personal knowledge, experience, and insights; other texts; and the world around them (e.g., *identify an issue depicted in a short story and do online research to explore different points of view about the issue; describe how the portrayal of teenage life and values in a feature article in a newspaper compares with their own experience*)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the significant differences between your views and the views expressed in this article? Has the information in the article changed your views on the issue in any way? What would have made the article more persuasive?”

Analysing Texts

- 1.6** analyse texts in terms of the information, ideas, issues, and themes they explore, examining how various aspects of the texts contribute to the presentation and development of these elements (e.g., *explain how the photographs, diagrams, and headings in a manual help the reader understand important technical information; explain the stanza structure of a poem and how it determines the organization of ideas in the poem*)

Teacher prompts: “Why are the diagrams and images included in the manual?” “What do you learn in the first stanza that helps you to understand the rest of the poem?”

Evaluating Texts

- 1.7** evaluate the effectiveness of texts, including increasingly complex texts, using evidence from the text to support their opinions (e.g., *comment on the strengths and weaknesses of a manual they have used to assemble a product; compare the usefulness for the reader of the titles, subtitles, and layout in a variety of how-to pamphlets*)

Teacher prompts: “Were the instructions clear enough to allow you to complete the task efficiently? Why or why not?” “Are the titles and subtitles used in this pamphlet helpful to the reader? Would additional headings make

the pamphlet more effective by making it easier to locate specific information?”

Critical Literacy

- 1.8** identify and analyse the perspectives and/or biases evident in texts, including increasingly complex texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., *identify the values represented in two conflicting online opinion pieces about an employment issue; identify the pattern of bias in three political cartoons by the same cartoonist*)

Teacher prompts: “What other perspectives might there be on the issue addressed in this opinion piece? What information is left out that might cast doubt on the perspective taken in the opinion piece?” “What assumptions might the author be making about the beliefs and values of the reader? What makes this evident?” “Who is the intended audience for this information? Who is ignored?”

2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

- 2.1** identify a variety of characteristics of informational, graphic, and literary text forms and explain how they help communicate meaning (e.g., *columns and rows are used to organize information in tables and charts; colour and contrast are used to show differences in a statistical comparison chart; the key words in headings and subheadings help the reader locate information in most informational text forms, such as résumés, trade apprenticeship texts, and manuals; stage directions help the reader visualize the action in a play; cause-and-effect patterns are often used to present explanations in reports*)

Teacher prompt: “Why does a résumé begin with a name and address? What is the purpose of each subheading in a résumé? How is the order of the subheadings chosen?”

Text Features

- 2.2** identify a variety of text features and explain how they help communicate meaning (e.g., *explain how graphs, flow charts, and timelines add or reinforce important details in business reports; compare how different magazines use colour, fonts, and page layout to attract their target audience*)

Teacher prompts: “Why do you think there are so many visual elements in this magazine?” “Why you think images and diagrams convey some types of information more efficiently than words do?”

Elements of Style

2.3 identify a variety of elements of style in texts, including increasingly complex texts, and explain how they help communicate meaning and enhance the effectiveness of the texts (*e.g., variety in sentence and paragraph lengths can affect readability and reader interest; the use of a symbol in an advertisement can create a particular impression about the product; the use of evocative words can help the reader visualize the characters in a short story; dialect, regional accents, or non-standard English can be used to reveal information about characters*)

Teacher prompts: “How do short, choppy sentences affect your interest in the text?” “What kinds of symbols would make you associate a product with youth culture?” “Which words in the short story help the reader to visualize its main character?”

3. Reading With Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

3.1 automatically understand most words in a variety of reading contexts (*e.g., words in grade-level texts; words found in texts on their favourite websites; terminology in technical and workplace texts*)

Teacher prompt: “These terms are used so frequently in the construction industry that most people use the acronyms for them. What does this acronym stand for?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

3.2 use appropriate decoding strategies to read and understand unfamiliar words (*e.g., discuss possible meanings of unfamiliar words with peers when participating in small-group, guided reading experiences; reread the sentence aloud to hear the unfamiliar word spoken in context; use print and electronic dictionaries to find the meanings of unfamiliar words*)

Teacher prompts: “What other word could you use here that would make sense in the sentence?” “Does this word look or sound like any other word you know?”

Developing Vocabulary

3.3 identify and use a variety of strategies to expand vocabulary, with a focus on vocabulary needed to function effectively as responsible citizens, pursue careers, and participate actively in the

community (*e.g., create a list of words used in transactions such as renting an apartment or buying a car; report on vocabulary learned in a co-op placement, a part-time job, or a volunteer placement; create a visual/verbal collage using the new vocabulary in a text*)

Teacher prompts: “Read to the class your list of the words that appeared most often in the employment ads you researched in your chosen field.” “Which words are commonly used at your part-time job? What strategies have you used to help you remember them?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after reading; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve as readers (*e.g., list the five reading strategies they found most helpful, and explain their choices; describe the benefits of reflecting on their reading practices and their progress as readers*)

Teacher prompts: “What questions did you ask yourself as you scanned the website for specific information? Which questions were most helpful?” “How did using sticky notes during reading help you to prepare your summary of the article?” “Which strategies do you think would help you most when you are reading longer texts? Why?”

Interconnected Skills

4.2 identify a variety of their skills in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing and explain how the skills help in their development as readers (*e.g., write a blog entry or an editorial for a student newsletter to explain the importance of this combination of skills in the complex world of work; record in your reading journal the insights into the novel that you gained from participating in a literature circle*)

Teacher prompts: “What did you learn by writing and illustrating this procedure that will help you to read procedural texts more effectively?” “How does talking to a partner after reading a section of a challenging technical text help you to understand the text?”

WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience;
- 2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of informational, graphic, and literary forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- 3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages in the writing process.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- 1.1** identify the topic, purpose, and audience for a variety of writing tasks (e.g., single paragraphs expressing their opinion of topics or issues discussed in class to prepare for a group discussion; a report for presentation to peers providing information on a topic of personal interest, including a table of contents and an overview of the subject, organizing their material under appropriate headings, observing conventions for proper documentation and full acknowledgement of sources and extracts, and using technological aids appropriate to the task, such as concept-mapping or presentation software;¹ a covering letter to accompany a résumé responding to a specific, advertised position)

Teacher prompts: “How will the contents of your covering letter [in application for a job] differ from the contents of your résumé?”
 “Judging from these samples, what is the purpose of an annual report, and who would its audience be?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- 1.2** generate, expand, explore, and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other

resources, as appropriate (e.g., use rapid writing to generate ideas for a topic;² as a class, complete a K-W-L chart to determine what they need to research about a topic; with a partner or in small groups, generate and record ideas for writing about a teacher-selected topic; use print, online, and other resources to gather ideas about a topic of their choice; in small groups and within a specific time frame, examine several advertisements and record their observations of patterns used in the marketing of products and/or services as a way to generate ideas for an opinion piece about advertising aimed at teenagers; accurately record all sources used to gather ideas and information, so that if they use the ideas and information, they can credit the original author, avoid plagiarism, and provide a complete bibliography or reference list)

Teacher prompts: “What ideas did you generate by completing the K-W-L chart?” “Which topics that you have already written about would you like to revisit?”

Research

- 1.3** locate and select information to appropriately support ideas for writing, using a variety of strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (e.g., create a research plan and track their progress using a research portfolio; identify and consult a range of sources that could provide appropriate information for their assignment, such as reference books,

1. TLCC 7-12 “Writing a Report” 144 2. TLCC 7-12 “Rapid Writing” 98

websites, and online databases, as well as resources available in community institutions such as public libraries and local businesses; interview representatives of volunteer organizations and community groups, where appropriate to their topic; record all sources of information in a list of works cited or bibliography, observing conventions for proper documentation and full acknowledgement of sources and extracts, in recognition of the need to credit original authors and promote academic honesty; use a template to evaluate sources and information for reliability, objectivity, and comprehensiveness; before completing their research, conduct a conference with their teacher and the teacher-librarian to help them determine whether the sources they have consulted to date are adequate and the information they have gathered is complete)

Teacher prompts: “What print and electronic sources are you considering using for your research? What additional sources could you consult?” “What criteria did you use to select the sources for your research?”

Organizing Ideas

- 1.4** identify, sort, and order main ideas and supporting details for writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and organizational patterns suited to the content and the purpose for writing (e.g., use index cards to organize information and ideas for writing reports; in small groups, cluster the key images and supporting details they will use in writing a poem;³ organize relevant factual information for a report into an introduction, a body, and a conclusion; use a concept map to rank the most and least important ideas and information in their notes,⁴ or use different coloured highlighters to colour-code their notes, ranking ideas and information from important to non-essential and/or irrelevant)

Teacher prompts: “Which of the ideas from your brainstorming session will you use in your poem? How did you select them?” “What order will you use to present the information you have gathered in your report?”

Reviewing Content

- 1.5** determine whether the ideas and information gathered are relevant to the topic, accurate, complete, and appropriately meet the requirements of the writing task (e.g., ask themselves questions about the reliability and objectivity of their sources and the accuracy, completeness, and relevance of the ideas and information they have gathered⁵)

Teacher prompts: “Have you used a variety of sources to research your topic?” “Do your sources represent a variety of perspectives? What additional sources could you consult to ensure that your work is credible?”

2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

- 2.1** write for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of informational, graphic, and literary forms (e.g., a how-to guide for a teenage audience on setting up a DVD player; a reflective narrative about a work experience that had a powerful effect on them, to be read aloud to peers; a presentation for jobless youth on preparing effective résumés)

Teacher prompts: “What points will you emphasize in your how-to guide? How would they differ if the guide were for adults?” “What graphic elements will you include in your how-to guide, and why?”

Voice

- 2.2** establish a distinctive voice in their writing, modifying language and tone skilfully to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., use clear and precise language in providing instructions; use evocative language, including metaphors and similes, to communicate emotions in a memoir; use descriptive language to establish a particular mood or tone in a poem or song lyric; use appropriate vocabulary to effectively convey excitement in an adventure story written for young children)

Teacher prompts: “What kind of language would you use to describe a delicious meal to let your audience know that you really enjoyed it?” “Why would the kind of language used in a set of instructions for adults be different from the kind used in a story written for young children?”

Diction

- 2.3** use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions to make their writing clear, vivid, and interesting for their intended audience (e.g., use figurative language to describe something in a poem; brainstorm to come up with a list of alternative, more effective words, phrases, and expressions to substitute for words they habitually use in their writing, and retain the list to consult for future writing assignments⁶)

3. TLE 10-12 “Finding Organizational Patterns – Poetry” 2 4. TLCC 7-12 “Most/Least Important Ideas” 44 5. TL Library Research 7-12 “Reacting to Reading: Critically Evaluating Resources” 20 6. TLE 10-12 “Sentence Starters” 46

Teacher prompts: “Are you using formal or informal language in this cartoon strip?” “What would be the effect on your audience if you used a different level of language for this poem?” “What specific words and terms have you used in your report to sound businesslike?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

2.4 write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and accurately, varying sentence type, structure, and length to suit different purposes and making smooth and logical transitions between ideas (*e.g., break a long, confusing sentence into two shorter, more effective sentences; use transitional phrases to show the relationship between ideas in two or more sentences or paragraphs*)

Teacher prompt: “What transitional words or phrases could you use in your paragraph to link ideas so that the reader could more easily follow your ideas?”

Critical Literacy

2.5 explain how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing (*e.g., examine their writing to check for bias and to determine whether their language and ideas are inclusive and non-discriminatory; draft lyrics for a song expressing their views on a social issue; write an opinion piece about a local political decision for a newspaper of their choice*)

Teacher prompts: “Does your narrative reflect your own values, or attitudes prevalent in popular culture?” “Are you trying to challenge your audience with the ideas expressed in your poem? How are you doing that?” “How are your own beliefs and values evident in this opinion piece?” “Have you avoided abusive or violent language?”

Revision

2.6 revise drafts to improve the content, organization, clarity, and style of their written work, using a variety of teacher-modelled strategies (*e.g., add transitional words and phrases to link sentences and/or paragraphs to improve the flow of their writing; examine their writing to determine if they have used stereotypes, and remove them; add or substitute words, phrases, and expressions that will make their writing more vivid*⁸)

Teacher prompts: “Have you used the appropriate level of language for your subject and audience?” “Have you examined your writing

for stereotypes?” “Have you provided enough detail to give your reader a full picture?”

Producing Drafts

2.7 produce revised drafts of texts, including increasingly complex texts, written to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Teacher prompt: “How well does your résumé represent your accomplishments to this particular employer?”

3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling

3.1 use knowledge of spelling rules and patterns, a variety of resources, and appropriate strategies to recognize and correct their own and others’ spelling errors (*e.g., use their knowledge of spelling patterns and words learned from teacher- and self-selected texts to help them spell words correctly; check their spellings in available print and electronic resources; apply their knowledge of root words, prefixes, and suffixes to spell technical words correctly*⁹)

Teacher prompt: “What is the root of that technical word you are using? What other strategies and resources can you use to ensure that you are spelling the word correctly?”

Vocabulary

3.2 build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meaning(s) and reviewing and refining word choice, using a variety of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose (*e.g., refer to classroom word walls;¹⁰ confirm or adjust meaning by relating words to their context; consult a variety of print and online resources that are appropriate to their purpose, including glossaries, word banks, and technical dictionaries, to confirm meanings of words; maintain lists of technical words encountered in trade or professional publications, and determine how these words are formed from root words, prefixes, and suffixes*¹¹)

Teacher prompt: “What resources could you use to avoid using the same word so often?”

7. TLE 10-12 “Revising and Editing: The Verb ‘To Be’” 56 8. TLCC 7-12 “Revising and Editing: Asking Questions to Revise Writing” 128 9. TLE 7-9 “Sample Roots and Prefixes” 54 10. TLCC 7-12 “Creating a Word Wall” 30 11. TLE 7-9 “Sample Roots and Prefixes” 54

Punctuation

3.3 use punctuation correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., use semicolons instead of coordinating conjunctions or transitional words to join two sentences with closely related content, before certain transitional words such as *however*, and to separate items in lists where the items already contain commas; use parentheses or dashes to set off supplementary material such as examples and definitions; use ellipses to indicate the omission of words or phrases from quotations)

Teacher prompt: “What other form of punctuation could you use to include this definition in your sentence?”

Grammar

3.4 use grammar conventions correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning clearly and fluently (e.g., use a variety of sentence types correctly in their writing; use verb tenses correctly in their writing; use unconventional grammar for effect¹²)

Teacher prompt: “When is it appropriate to use a slang expression? When is it not appropriate?”

Proofreading

3.5 proofread and correct their writing, using guidelines developed with the teacher and peers (e.g., review drafts using an editing checklist specific to the writing task; ask their peers to proofread their work, and use the feedback to make corrections¹³; read their sentences aloud)

Teacher prompt: “Have you reviewed, checked, and corrected the spelling and punctuation errors your partner pointed out?”

Publishing

3.6 use a variety of presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to heighten its appeal for their audience (e.g., select the most appropriate fonts, graphics, and layout to create polished and professional-looking reports;¹⁴ use clear fonts and graphics that are appropriate to their topic to create an effective presentation using presentation software)

Teacher prompts: “What font will give your report a businesslike appearance?” “What are the advantages of varying the font size in a brochure?”

Producing Finished Works

3.7 produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations (e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions)

Teacher prompt: “What important points have you learned about creating a good news story? What criteria should you include on a checklist for news stories that you could review before submitting your finished work?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after writing; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify appropriate steps they can take to improve as writers (e.g., describe how using a graphic organizer to organize their ideas improved their ability to write reports; describe how asking peers to review their drafts helped them improve their writing; compare their present writing skills with those required in workplace situations, and set specific goals for improvement)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies did you use to organize the research for your report, and how effective were they?” “What did you learn from your writing partner’s comments on your work?” “What specific aspects of your writing do you think you need to improve to help you do well in your chosen career?”

Interconnected Skills

4.2 identify a variety of skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them write more effectively (e.g., describe how being an observant viewer when watching television and an attentive listener when interacting with friends helps them find ideas for their writing)

Teacher prompts: “How can carefully observing the actions of characters in a film or television series help you better depict the motivation of the characters in your own narratives?” “How has listening to your friends talk about their lives, interests, and concerns given you ideas to use in your writing?”

12. TLE 10-12 “Modelled Writing” 51 13. TLCC 7-12 “Peer Editing” 132 14. TLCC 7-12 “Writing a Report” 144-147

Portfolio

- 4.3** select a variety of types of writing that they think most clearly reflect their growth and competence as writers, and explain the reasons for their choice (*e.g., select finished pieces of writing for a portfolio that prospective employers will review, and explain why they think the pieces are good examples of their work; prepare an anthology of their writing, selecting pieces that reveal the range of their skills as writers*)

Teacher prompt: “Which pieces of your writing will best demonstrate both your writing skills and your maturity to prospective employers? Explain why.”

MEDIA STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Understanding Media Texts:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of media texts;
- 2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques:** identify some media forms and explain how the conventions and techniques associated with them are used to create meaning;
- 3. Creating Media Texts:** create a variety of media texts for different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques;
- 4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as media interpreters and creators, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in understanding and creating media texts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Understanding Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- 1.1** explain how media texts, including increasingly complex texts, are created to suit particular purposes and audiences (*e.g., horror movies use a unique villain, special effects, night-time settings, and teenage characters as victims to appeal to a teenage audience; apprenticeship training brochures include images of smiling young people in the uniform of their trade, and quotes from skilled workers who completed apprenticeship training and found lucrative jobs, to encourage students to enrol in apprenticeship training*¹)

Teacher prompts: “Why do instruction manuals and instructional videos supplement explanations with graphics?” “Why do television reality shows provide opportunities for audience participation and feedback?”

Interpreting Messages

- 1.2** interpret media texts, including increasingly complex texts, identifying and explaining the overt and implied messages they convey (*e.g., identify the implied messages that safety brochures use to strengthen their overt messages about following workplace safety rules and procedures;*² *identify clues in radio advertisements that indicate who the broadcaster’s target audience is*)

Teacher prompt: “What kinds of implied messages do safe-sex ads use to try to convince people of the urgent need to take appropriate precautions?”

Evaluating Texts

- 1.3** evaluate how effectively information, ideas, issues, and opinions are communicated in media texts, including increasingly complex texts, and decide whether the texts achieve their intended purpose (*e.g., determine how effectively a CD cover communicates the appeal of the artist and of his or her new collection of songs to its target audience; determine how well a company website conveys the impression of good management and responsible corporate citizenship to its employees or customers*)

Teacher prompt: “What aspects of Remembrance Day television coverage are most effective in conveying how people’s lives are affected by war? What could it do better?”

Audience Responses

- 1.4** explain why the same media text might prompt different responses from different audiences (*e.g., explain what attracts different people to different local newspapers, taking into account both design and content; explain why young children might respond differently than seniors to the playlist and advertising on a local radio station*)

1. TL Media 7-10 “Exploring the Key Concepts of Media Literacy” 2 TL Media 7-10 “Reading Graphical Texts” 6

Teacher prompt: “What differences would you predict between the responses of children and adults or teenagers and adults to a prime-time cartoon?”

Critical Literacy

- 1.5** identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in media texts, including increasingly complex texts, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., comment on the different perspectives on an issue revealed in the news websites of different cultural groups*)

Teacher prompts: “How do these websites reflect the values and concerns of their target audiences?” “With what cultures do you identify, and to what degree are your cultural values reflected in the evening news or on prime-time television?”

Production Perspectives

- 1.6** explain how a variety of production, marketing, and distribution factors influence the media industry (*e.g., explain why authors attend book-signing events to coincide with the release of their books*)

Teacher prompt: “Why are there Canadian versions of American magazines and television shows? What are the advantages and disadvantages of this practice? Who benefits?”

2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

- 2.1** identify general and specific characteristics of a variety of media forms and explain how they shape content and create meaning (*e.g., explain how the differences between a website, a radio broadcast, a blog, and a television newscast affect their coverage of a news event*)

Teacher prompts: “What details might tell you that the photographs of a wedding have been taken by guests rather than by a professional wedding photographer?” “What does a televised current events program provide its audience that a national newscast does not?”

Conventions and Techniques

- 2.2** identify conventions and/or techniques that are used in a variety of media forms and explain how they convey meaning and influence their audience (*e.g., trade shows showcase the products of various manufacturers and/or service providers in a particular trade for the*

benefit of practitioners, distributing samples and informative literature and holding contests to engage the interest of their audience)

Teacher prompts: “Is it likely that a movie trailer will tell you how the movie ends? Why or why not?” “What techniques or conventions might a wedding videographer use to enhance the romantic atmosphere of the filmed event?”

3. Creating Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- 3.1** describe the topic, purpose, and audience for media texts they plan to create (*e.g., a storyboard for a company video to provide new employees with essential information about the workplace*³), and identify significant challenges they may face in achieving their purpose

Teacher prompt: “What is the target market for the new line of work clothing you want to promote? Which means of advertising is most likely to reach your market – radio, television, magazines, or the Internet?”

Form

- 3.2** select a media form to suit the topic, purpose, and audience for a media text they plan to create, and explain why it is an appropriate choice (*e.g., explain why a videotape is an appropriate way to describe how to use a video camera; explain why a photographic exhibit highlighting features of the cooperative education program is a good way to interest students in the program*)

Teacher prompts: “Which form do you think would be most likely to help you reach your audience? Why?” “Why would you use a video instead of a printed manual to explain how to use a video camera?”

Conventions and Techniques

- 3.3** identify a variety of conventions and/or techniques appropriate to a media form they plan to use, and explain how these will help them communicate specific aspects of their intended meaning (*e.g., conventions/techniques for a storyboard for a workplace safety video: descriptions of the camera angles and types of shots to be used and their purpose*)

Teacher prompts: “What features should you include on a security pass for employees of a hospital?” “What techniques would you use in a radio advertisement for a product intended for teenagers?”

Producing Media Texts

3.4 produce media texts for a variety of purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques (e.g., a captioned photo essay on an Aboriginal issue; a web page about the school for students new to the school)

Teacher prompt: “What will you include in your video essay about the cooperative education program at your school? Will you interview students and employers at work placements?” “How will you ensure that your website appeals to a diverse range of students?”

4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used in interpreting and creating media texts, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify appropriate steps they can take to

improve as media interpreters and producers (e.g., determine how analysing examples of effective career recruitment posters helped them create their own)

Teacher prompt: “How did investigating the interests of the intended audience for your media text influence your choices of colour, font size, and images?”

Interconnected Skills

4.2 identify a variety of their skills in listening, speaking, reading, and writing and explain how the skills help them interpret and produce media texts (e.g., participating in a debate about school spirit can help them find a focusing theme for the campaign of a student council candidate)

Teacher prompt: “How could reading about a specific trade help you promote it as a potential career to an audience of your peers?”